



Old warhorses: Cheteshwar Pujara and Ajinkya Rahane have fallen out of favour with the national selectors in recent times. GETTYIMAGES

CAN RANJI TROPHY PASS THE TEST OF TIME?

In recent years, excelling in the IPL has generally expedited a player's inclusion in the Indian team, often surpassing those who **diligently contribute** in the domestic season.

Shayan Acharya

shayan.acharya@thehindu.co.in

It's that time of the year again when India's domestic talents don the whites and gear up for three months of red-ball cricket. The conditions would vary, the challenges would be different, and the competition would be intense.

In the current era, white-ball cricket often overshadows the longer

format, prompting ongoing debates about the significance of the Ranji Trophy, India's premier tournament. The tournament faces challenges as it coincides with the international cricket calendar, leading to the absence of many star players. This trend is likely to persist this time, even with a two-week gap between India's Test series against South

Africa and the subsequent home series against England. Despite this, **over a thousand cricketers from various regions will aspire to showcase their skills, recognising that consistent performances may still not guarantee a spot in Team India.**

In recent years, excelling in the Indian Premier League (IPL) has generally expedited a player's